

Rooks belong behind many passers

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A rook behind a passed pawn often becomes more active as the pawn advances, whether the pawn is friendly or hostile. This is a useful guideline, not an absolute rule. Side checks, promotion tactics, and king shelter can favor another placement.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Behind your own passer, the rook supports each forward step. Behind an enemy passer, it can attack the pawn while retaining checking distance. A rook in front may be tied down and lose room as the pawn advances.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

When can the guideline fail?

ANSWER AND REASONING

When a tactical promotion threat, a safe blockade, or a stronger checking position requires a different square. Calculate immediate moves before relocating a rook just to match the rule.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use rook placement to preserve activity as the pawn moves.